Experiment 8

FINAURA frontend improvements through software design principles

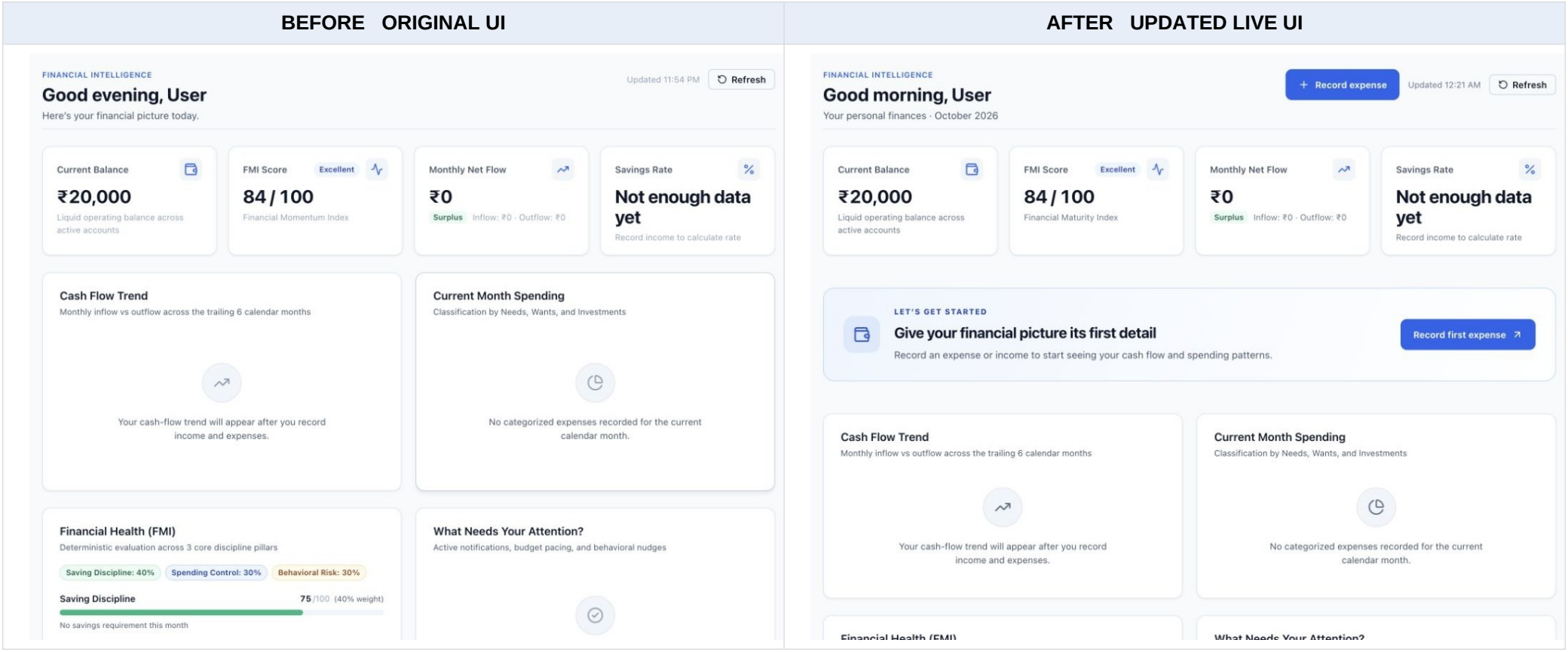
Hypothetical user feedback

These fabricated comments illustrate possible feedback that could motivate the UI changes. They are not collected participant responses. Person numbers match the numbered comparisons that follow.

Person	Hypothetical feedback
Person 1	The overview is mostly empty charts. I cannot tell where to start or how to record my first expense.
Person 2	I have not added any transactions, so why does the page say none match my filters? Please explain how to begin.
Person 3	I am unsure which expense details to enter first and when to check the category. Please tell me beside the amount field if zero is invalid.
Person 4	I have not recorded any spending yet. How can the app say my spending is disciplined? Show when there is too little data to analyze.
Person 5	What does 0.25th percentile mean? I need a clear label and a short explanation of how the reliable income figure should be read.
Person 6	I have not completed my retirement details, but the contribution panel says Fully Funded. Please show when a calculation is not available.
Person 7	I want to try an exact monthly investment of 12750. The sliders make precise values difficult to enter and compare.
Person 8	I just want to download my records. The large technical explanation distracts me from the download choices; make those details optional.
Person 9	What happens after I invite someone to my family? Please show whether they must accept and when the shared household view becomes available.
Person 10	The Profile page mainly shows future features. I want to see my current account details and saved financial information first.

Original UI on the left and implemented live UI on the right. Screenshots use the same local test account and are cropped to the relevant workspace.

1 Overview

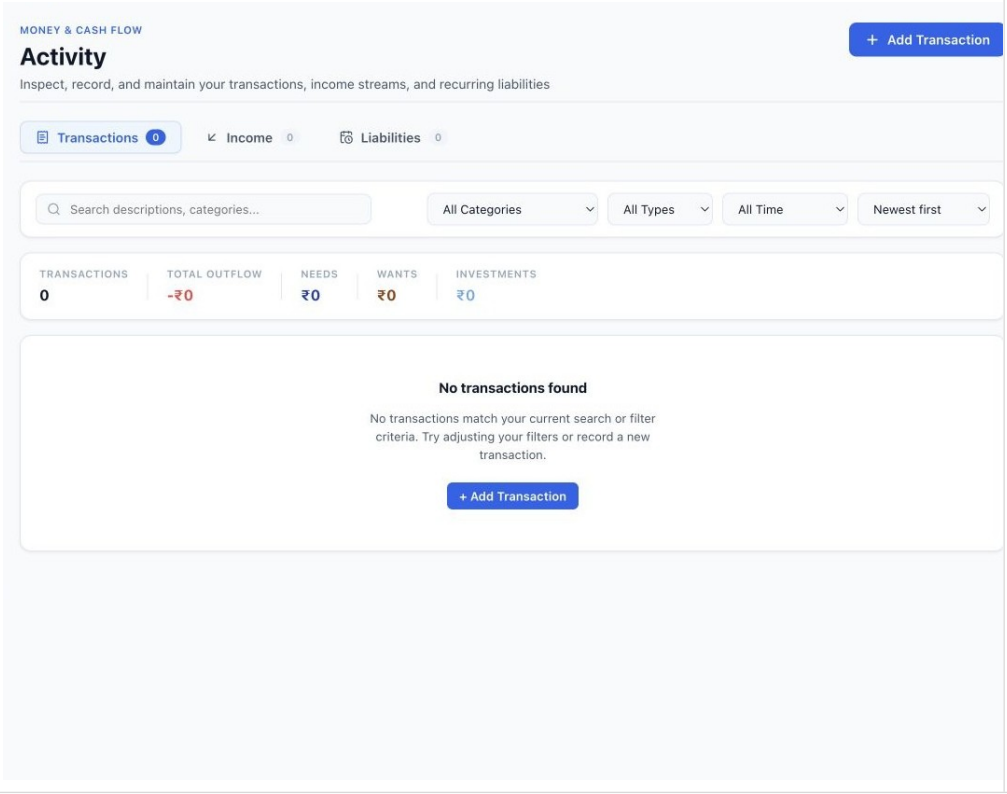
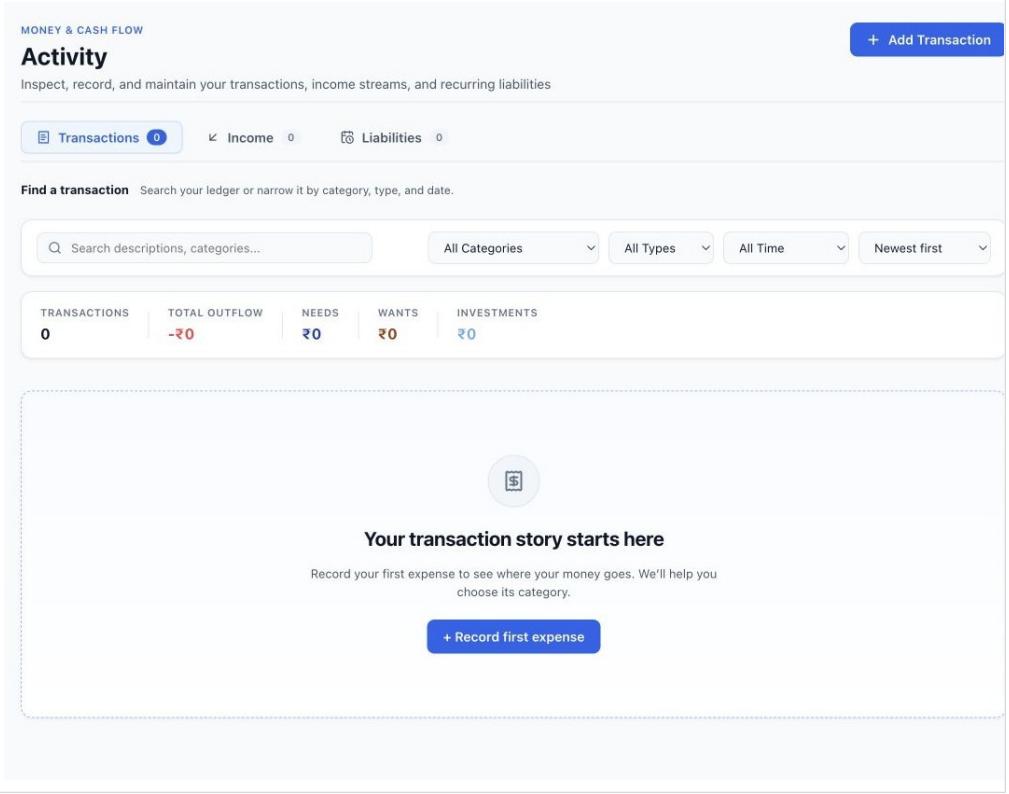


Before Large empty charts dominated the overview without a clear first action.

After A first expense panel and Record expense button guide the user; empty charts take less space.

Design principle Recognition and visual hierarchy make the next task obvious. A reusable NextStep component keeps first use guidance consistent.

2 Transactions

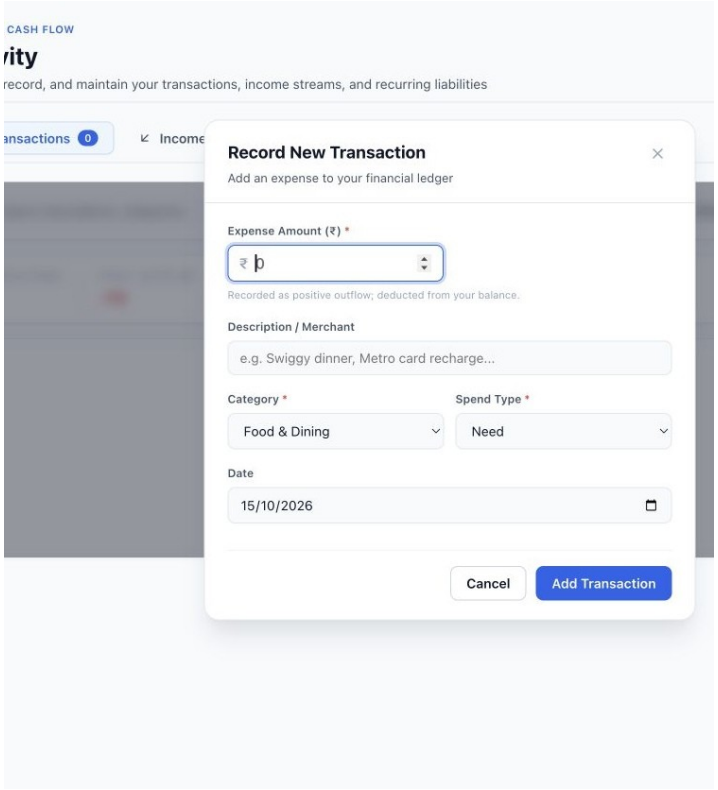
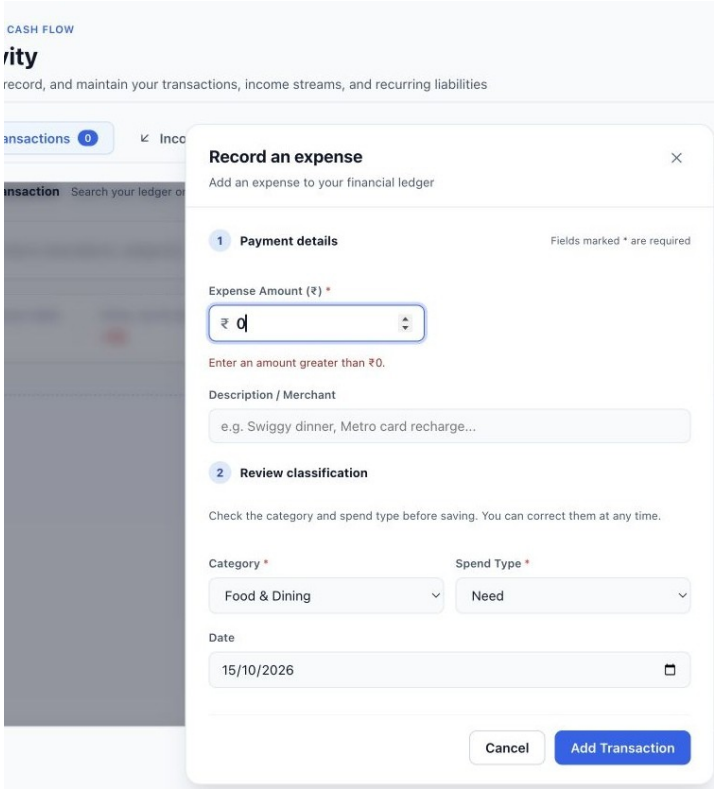
BEFORE ORIGINAL UI	AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI
	

Before An empty account was described as having no transactions matching the filters.

After The empty ledger now explains how to begin and offers Record first expense. Filter guidance is explicit.

Design principle Visibility of system status distinguishes an empty ledger from a filtered search with no matches.

3 Expense entry

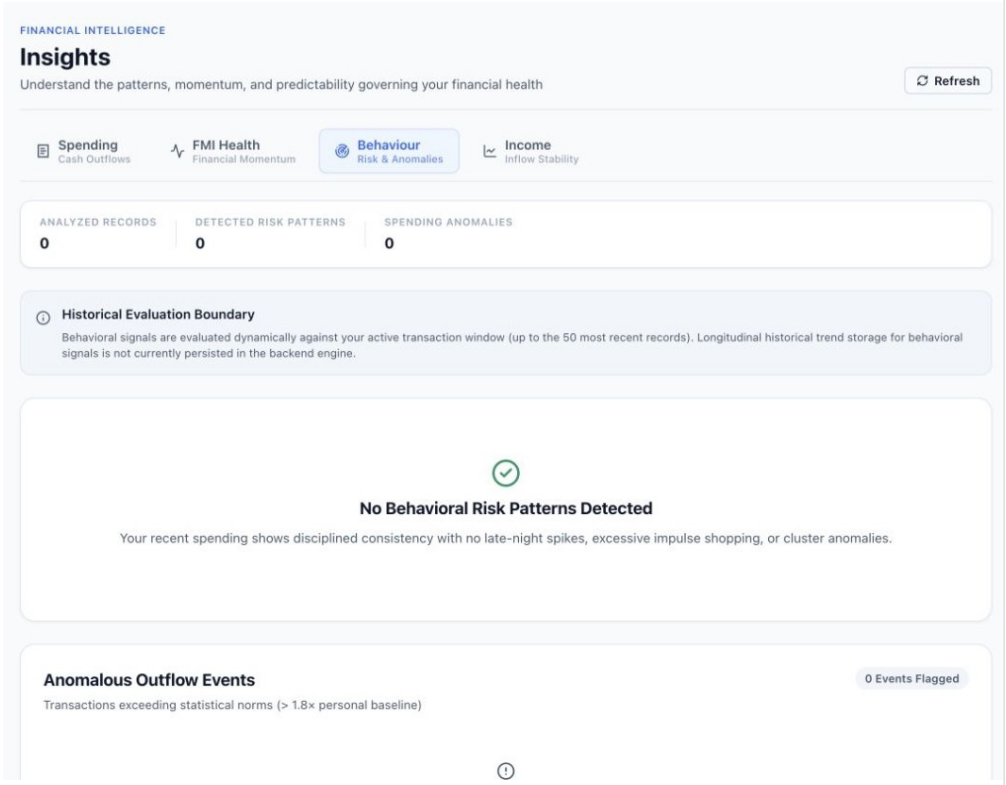
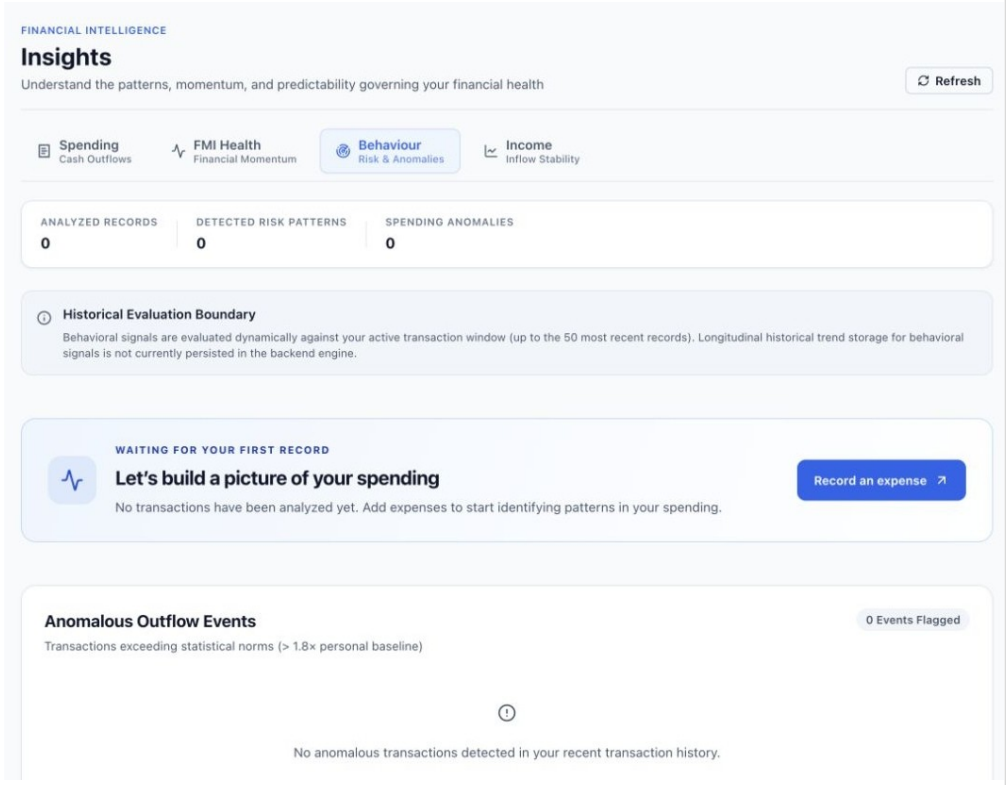
BEFORE ORIGINAL UI	AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI
	

Before The form presented payment and classification fields without a clear review sequence.

After Numbered sections separate payment details from classification review. A zero amount shows an inline error.

Design principle Error prevention gives immediate, field specific feedback. Shared Input and Modal components encapsulate accessible error and keyboard behavior.

4 Behaviour insights

BEFORE ORIGINAL UI	AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI
	

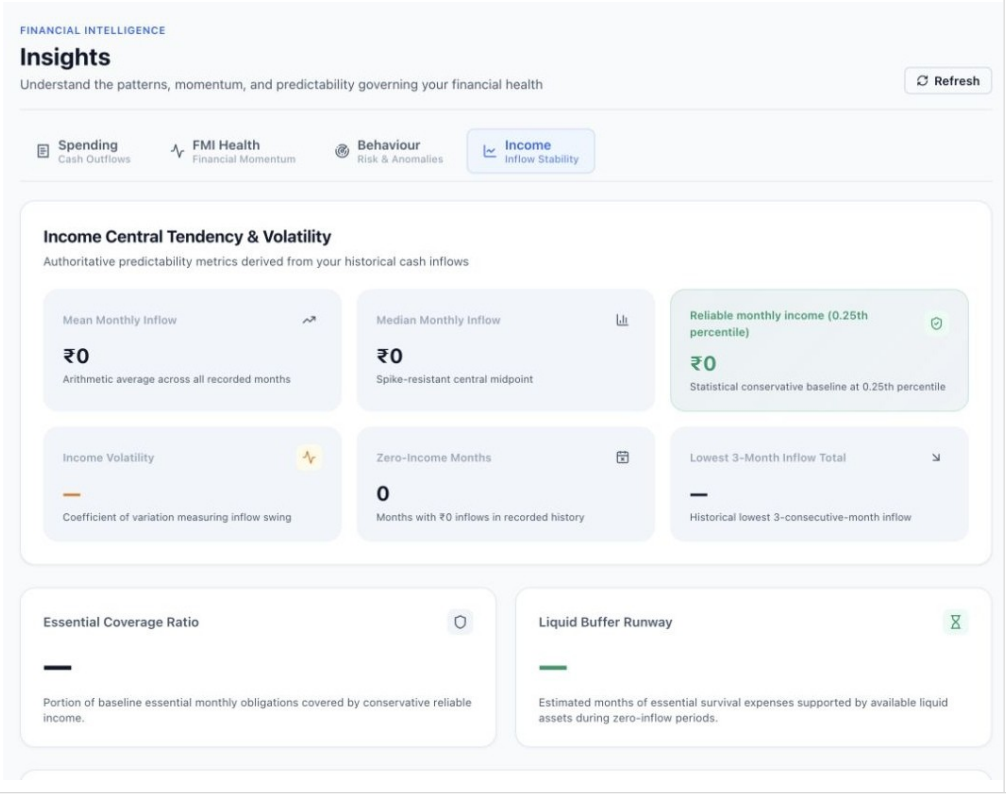
Before Positive spending messages appeared even though no transactions had been analyzed.

After A waiting for your first record state explains the missing evidence and links to expense entry.

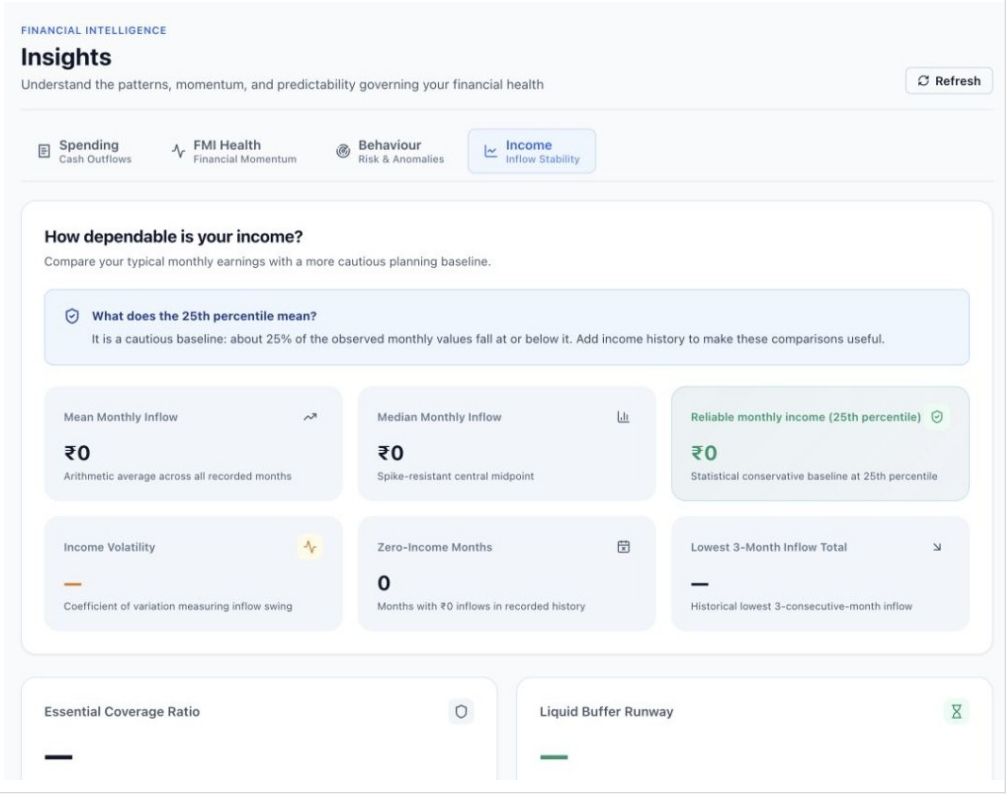
Design principle Visibility of system status avoids presenting missing analysis as a positive conclusion.

5 Income insights

BEFORE ORIGINAL UI



AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI

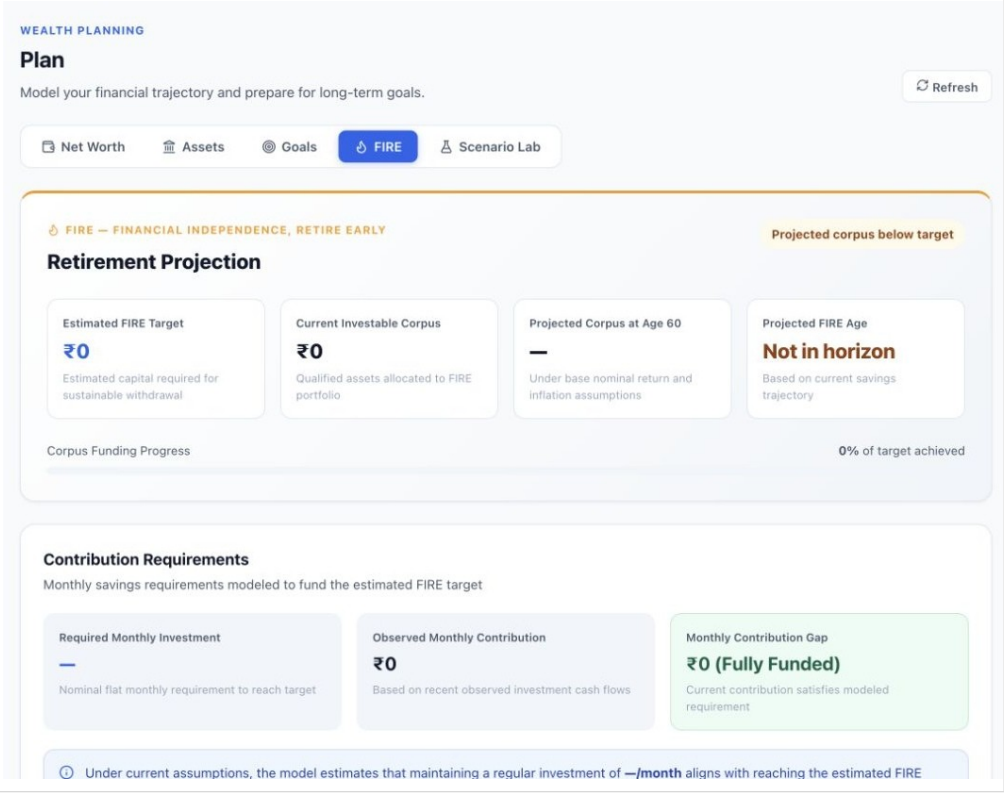
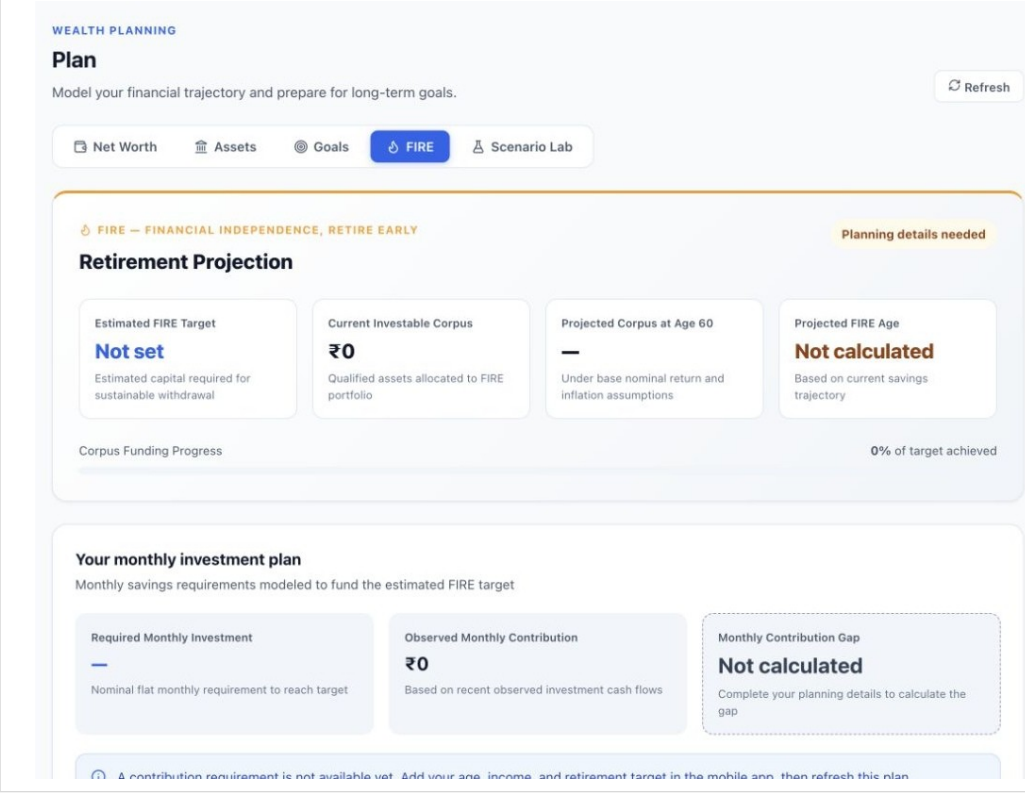


Before The safe income label displayed the fractional percentile as 0.25th percentile.

After The label shows 25th percentile and a short explanation describes what the figure means.

Design principle Abstraction normalizes the API fraction before display. Consistency and plain language keep the label and explanation aligned.

6 Retirement planning

BEFORE ORIGINAL UI	AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI
	

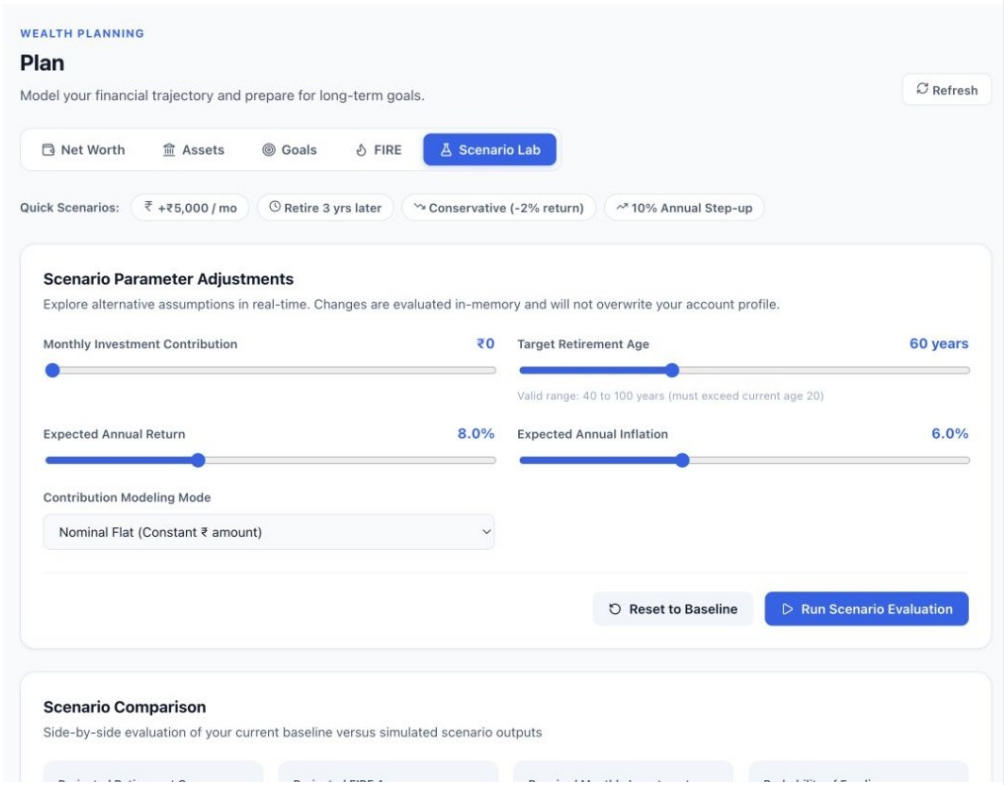
Before Missing planning inputs produced a Fully Funded contribution status and zero valued targets.

After Missing targets show Not set or Not calculated. The contribution panel requests the details needed for a calculation.

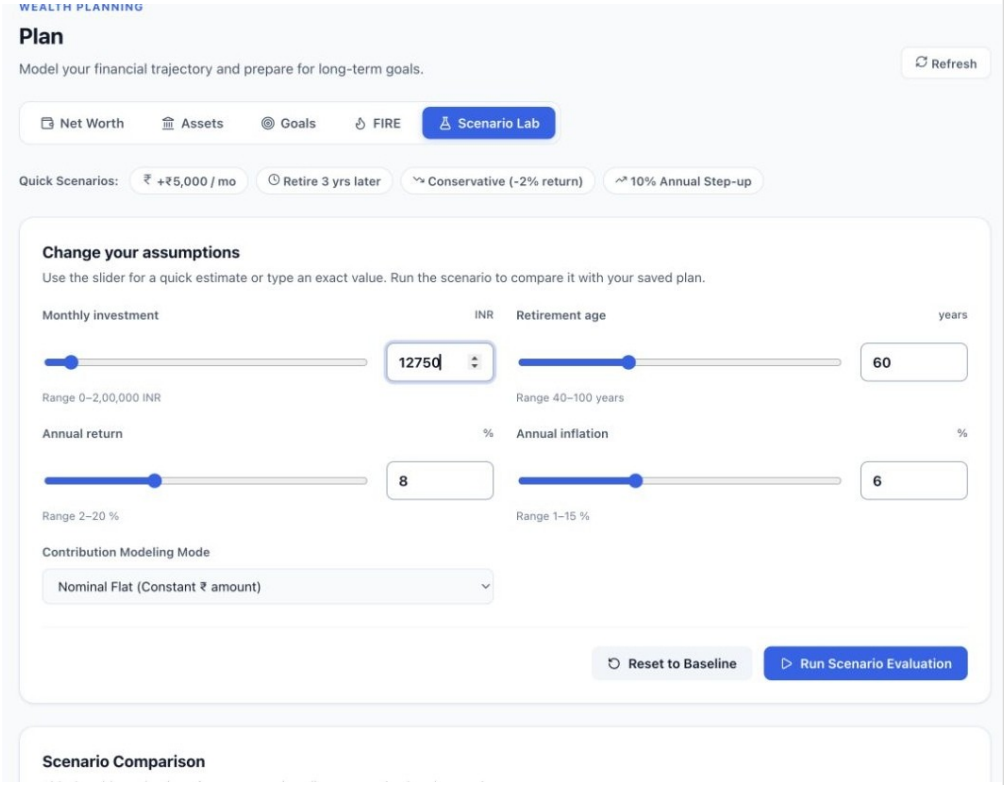
Design principle Explicit state modeling and error prevention separate unavailable calculations from a valid zero contribution gap.

7 Scenario inputs

BEFORE ORIGINAL UI



AFTER UPDATED LIVE UI

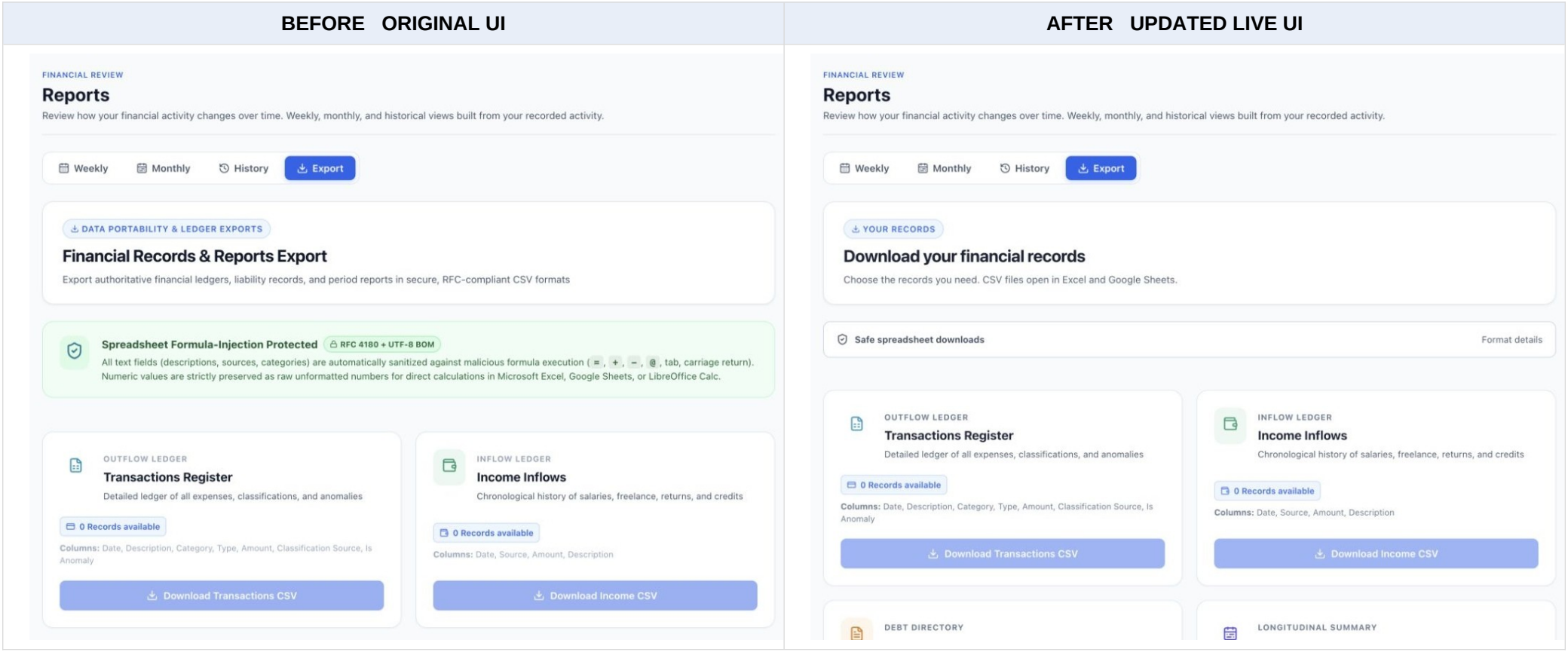


Before Sliders made precise assumptions difficult to enter and compare.

After Each main assumption pairs a slider with an exact numeric field. The monthly investment example is 12750.

Design principle User control supports both quick adjustment and precise entry. The reusable RangeField keeps values, bounds, labels, and validation together.

8 Report exports

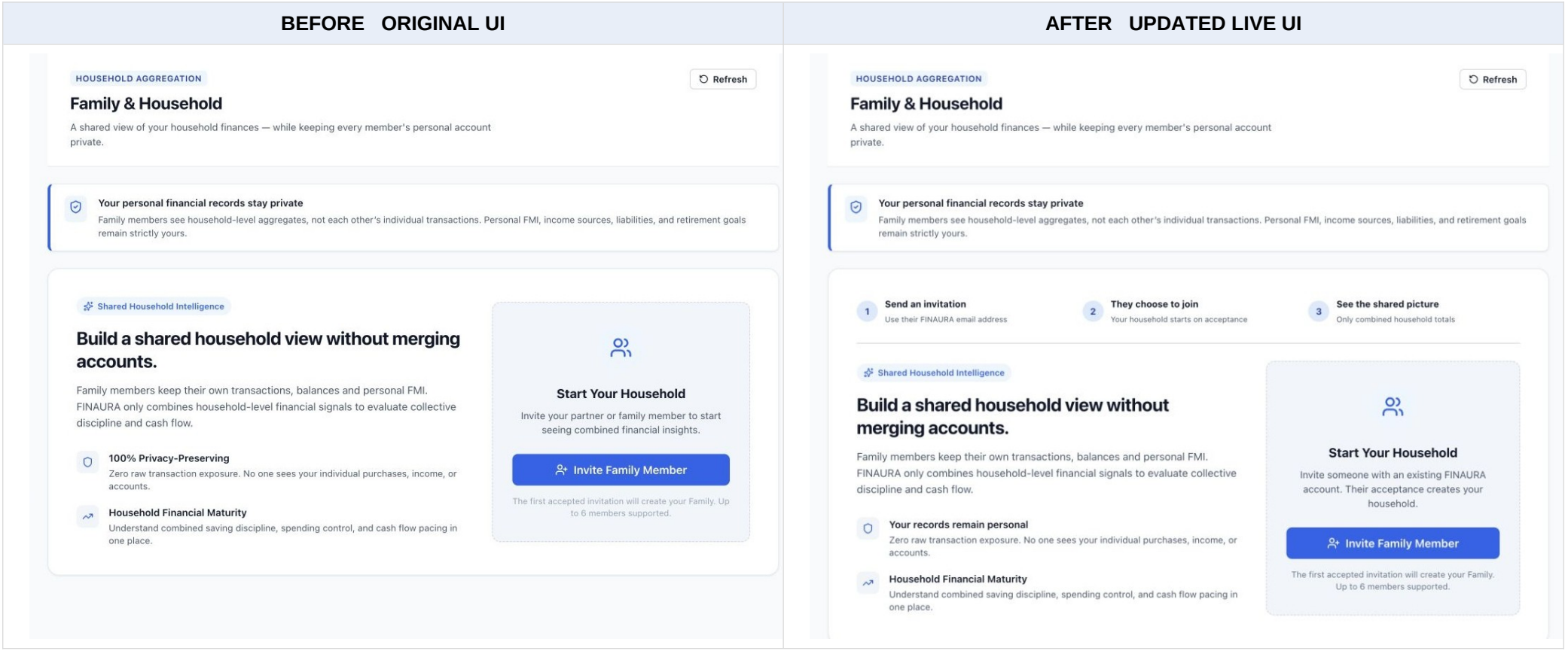


Before A large technical security explanation occupied space above the download choices.

After Download choices move higher. Format and spreadsheet safety details remain available in an expandable section.

Design principle Progressive disclosure prioritizes the main task while retaining supporting technical information.

9 Family setup

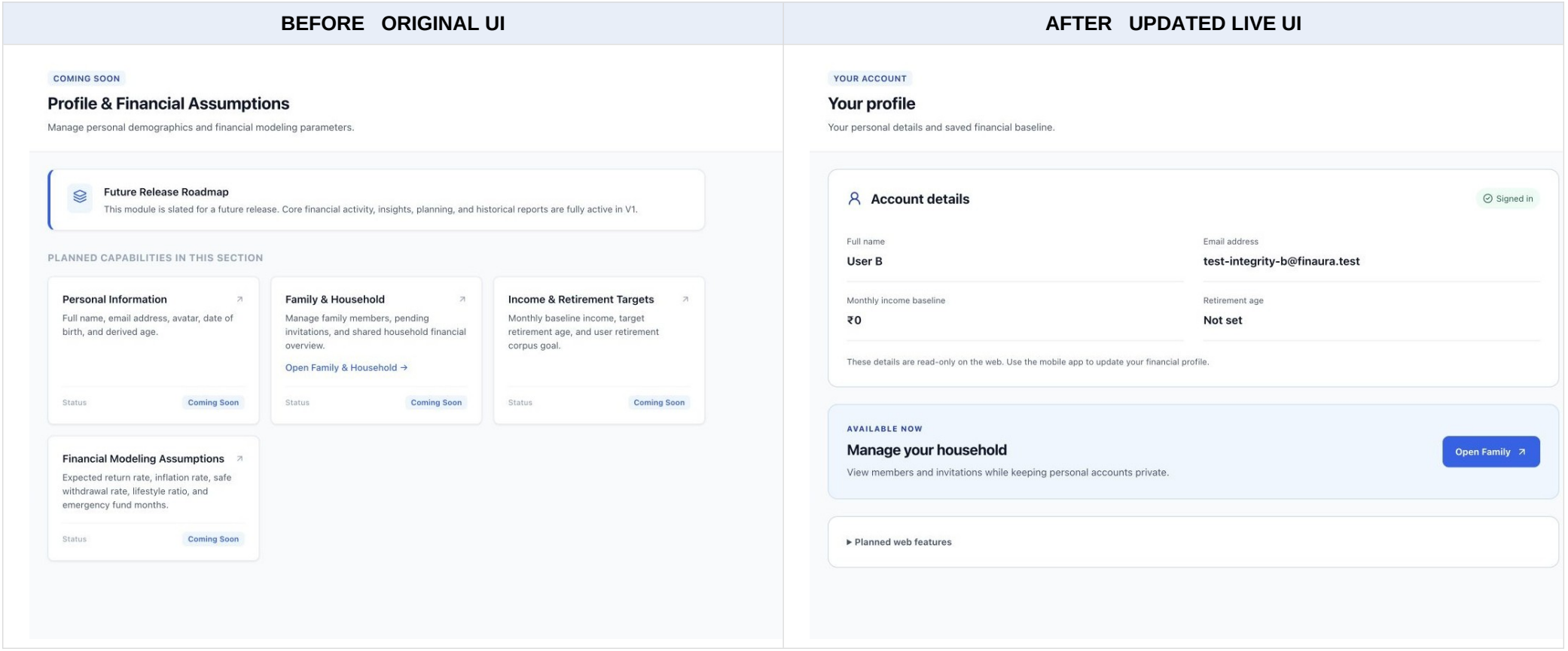


Before The setup card described household features without a visible invitation sequence.

After Three visible steps explain invitation, acceptance, and the shared household view.

Design principle Recognition reduces the need to infer the workflow. Clear sequencing explains what happens after an invitation.

10 Profile



Before The profile route mainly displayed planned features and roadmap content.

After The page shows current account details and saved financial baseline, with a working Family shortcut. Future features are collapsed.

Design principle Visibility of system status exposes useful current information. Progressive disclosure gives planned features less prominence.